

**RIP MS Paint**

Microsoft will be axing MSPaint from Windows with the arrival of the Fall Creators Update.
<http://digit.in/RIPMSPaint>

**Russia to ban proxies**

Russia's lower house of the Parliament passed a bill banning proxy websites, servers and VPNs.
<http://digit.in/RussPrxy>

THE DIGIT COMMUNITY IS FILLED WITH BRIGHT IDEAS and we find the best among the best every month to bring them to you in this section.

How mixed reality will transform the way we work, play, and live



Taking virtual tours to the surface of the moon or Mars will become a reality soon

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e live in an era dominated by digital screens, as they regularly lure us away from investing time

into real-world activities. Our choices of having fun have shifted to the virtual world while ignoring and limiting real-life pleasures. Don't believe us? Try recalling a recent memory where you actually went out to enjoy the rain rather than playing games on your smartphone indoors. You can't, right? That's what we thought. However, we are on the verge of witnessing and being a part of a massive change. The convergence between the real and virtual world through mixed reality is here. We will try to explore how are we going to benefit from this upcoming wave of innovation in various professional fields and even our homes.

In 1994, Paul Milgram and Fumio Kishino defined mixed reality as "one in which real world and virtual world objects are presented together within a single display, that is, anywhere between the extrema of the Reality-Virtuality continuum". We know how it's already functional in gaming. Let's briefly have a look at how mixed reality is going to affect our lives in other fields.

AUTOMOTIVE DESIGN

Suppose the lead designer of a sports car manufacturer is testing the aerodynamic capabilities of a concept car. The designer wants to verify the effects of wind on the surface of the car. To deduce the possibilities, there are two approaches. The wind effects can either be simulated using computer software or by physically carrying out

the experiment in an expensive wind tunnel facility. Introducing mixed reality in this scenario will let the designer visualise the entire simulation without going to a wind tunnel. Also, designers will be able to interact with projections for more control and granular results.

COMPLEX SURGERY

Surgeries assisted by AR/VR technology has always been a wet dream in the medical field. Complex operations can become super-efficient and drastically drop the level of risk associated in the surgery. Imagine a brain surgery is underway and the surgeons are wearing a mixed reality headset. With sensors embedded in the patient's brain, data can be transmitted to the headset. This data will be in the form of a live feed giving more information about the health and circulation in the brain. The entire setup will also highlight precautions and raise flags in case of any anomalous behaviour. It will also act as a safety mechanism. For instance, it could notify the surgeon of veins that need to be reconnected after the surgery.

GROCERY SHOPPING

It might sound absurd at the beginning but hear us out. Groceries being

delivered right to the comfort of our homes is convenient. In the future, consumers will be able to negotiate the prices of groceries with the vendors using live video directly. Imagine taking a virtual tour of a grocery store and checking whether the available fruits and vegetables are fresh enough. We are pretty sure they are in the pipeline somewhere, and we are pretty excited about trying something like that out.

According to data from IDC, the total number of AR and VR headsets shipped in 2016 was around 10.1 million units, and they predict the number to rise to about 99.4 million by 2021. However, it will take some more time for this sector to enter our country compared to the rest of the world. Several companies including Google, HTC, Microsoft, and Oculus are working towards making it happen with their mixed reality devices. Along with headsets, wearable devices are also being tinkered with to introduce them into the same ecosystem.

To make it go mainstream, we'll need more companies to join and come out with economical solutions while other companies keep delivering software content. And particularly in our country, we'll need better network infrastructure. Here's to hoping for a wonderful mixed reality in the future. 